

**SYNTHETIC TRAINING RECORD — FICTIONAL PARTIES, PEOPLE,  
AGENCIES, SYSTEMS, IDENTIFIERS, AND EVENTS — NOT A REAL  
FILING OR CYBERSECURITY GUIDE**

# **Consolidated Public Motion to Maintain Sealing**

**Filed:** November 11, 2025 **Synthetic docket:** SYN-DMD-25-CV-0914 **Movant:** Fictional United States Department of Energy

DOE moves under the fictional Court’s application of D. Md. Local Rule 105.11 to maintain sealed treatment of the controlled counterparts filed with the summary-judgment record. Public redacted counterparts have been or will be filed for every identified item. The public versions use descriptive notices; the controlled versions use only inert exercise labels.

The requested restriction covers the sealed Vaughn indexes, controlled sample playbooks, highlighted party memoranda, and the controlled in-camera declaration. DOE asserts that those materials show relationships among nonpublic operational and human-safety categories. Although all content is synthetic, the access structure is designed to model adjudication of an asserted protected interest.

DOE proposes that the controlled set remain sealed through final resolution of the district action and any appeal, unless the Court orders otherwise. It does not seek closure of the docket, the public motion, or any public counterpart.

This consolidated request identifies the materials in groups because DOE says the same interests recur. The accompanying certificate lists every pair and confirms public availability. DOE submits that aggregate treatment is appropriate for the common category relationships and asks the Court to review the controlled copies in camera.

## **Materials Covered by the Request**

The first group contains the primary public and sealed Vaughn pair and the supplemental public and sealed Vaughn pair. The controlled indexes use inert labels at the semantic positions where the public versions display category notices. DOE asserts that the controlled presentation is needed for the Court to assess its exemption explanations.

The second group contains paired samples of the Operational Decision Tree, Cyber-Incident Escalation Matrix, and Response-Coordination Playbook Appendix. Each public record has an equal-page controlled counterpart. The samples concern abstract field types only and contain no actual operational values.

The third group contains the public and highlighted versions of Open Grid's opening memorandum, DOE's cross-motion and opposition, and Open Grid's reply. The fourth group contains the public and controlled in-camera declarations. Every controlled item is identified again in the sealed-materials chart.

DOE states broadly that disclosure of controlled category relationships could undermine the interests asserted under Exemptions 7(E) and 7(F). It does not offer a distinct harm narrative for each document in this consolidated motion. Instead, it relies on the same operational-organization and human-function concerns across the set.

## **Asserted Need for Restricted Access**

DOE contends that the controlled documents permit comparison of decision, ordering, guideline, duty, safety, and communication field types. Public disclosure of the fuller semantic placement, it argues, would reveal more about the claimed relationships than the public notices alone.

The asserted 7(E) interest is protection of nonpublic implementation organization and guideline relations. The asserted 7(F) interest is avoidance of interference with protective human functions. DOE incorporates its declarations and cross-motion rather than restating a document-specific connection for every sealed item.

The controlled labels are harmless inventions. DOE nevertheless asks the Court to treat their arrangement as if it represented confidential source material so the exercise tests sealing procedure under a realistic claim. No actual person, agency system, physical location, contact path, or response method is contained in the exhibits.

DOE submits that access should be limited to the Court, authorized personnel, and counsel operating under the litigation restrictions. Possession of a public counterpart would not authorize access to its sealed partner. The request concerns judicial-record access only and creates no authority over any underlying agency repository.

## Alternatives Considered

DOE considered filing only public redacted versions. It rejected that option because the Court would then see the asserted categories without the controlled semantic context. It considered describing all relationships in a single declaration, but concluded that the Court would lose page-level correspondence with the records and memoranda.

DOE also considered redacting the controlled counterparts line by line. It states generally that repeated removals would obscure the category relationships for which in-camera review is sought. The motion does not specify, document by document, which portions could remain public within the controlled filings or why each entire counterpart must be restricted.

The selected alternative is paired filing. Every sealed item has an independently worded public counterpart of equal length. Public notices disclose the kind of field asserted without revealing the inert label. The open docket therefore presents the facts, legal positions, and existence of each category.

DOE contends that pairing is less restrictive than sealing both versions or closing the summary-judgment record. Open Grid may oppose the breadth of the request and argue for passage-specific treatment. The Court may inspect the pairs before determining whether the common explanation supports the full requested scope.

## **Public Notice and Proposed Duration**

This motion is filed publicly and identifies the controlled materials by title. DOE requests that it remain available for at least fourteen days before the Court rules, providing notice and an opportunity for objection under the fictional application of Local Rule 105.11.

The proposed seal would last through entry of final judgment, completion of any appeal, and return of jurisdiction to the district court. DOE asks that the restriction then continue until further order unless a party moves to alter it. The proposal does not assign different durations to evidentiary samples, advocacy filings, or declarations.

DOE states that a common duration avoids inconsistent access treatment while the same exemption and segregation questions remain under review. It also acknowledges that the Court may require later reconsideration and that controlled copies should not remain closed merely because the case has ended.

Public counterparts are intended to remain accessible throughout. Their availability permits the public to understand the parties' positions and the Court's reasoning. The controlled set contains no real operational content, but its restricted status preserves the procedural premise of the synthetic dispute.

## Requested Order

DOE asks the Court to accept the controlled counterparts for in-camera consideration, maintain them under seal for the proposed duration, and direct that access occur only through the Court's authorized process. It further asks that the public counterparts remain the ordinary docket versions.

The requested order would cover the primary and supplemental Vaughn twins; the decision-tree, escalation-matrix, and coordination-appendix twins; the three pairs of summary-judgment memoranda; and the in-camera declaration pair. The accompanying certificate confirms the corresponding public item for each controlled filing.

DOE relies on a common finding that the sealed set contains category relationships bearing on asserted operational and human-safety interests, that public twins provide an alternative, and that unrestricted access would defeat the purpose of controlled review. It does not request separate findings for each page in this motion.

Corin Pell certifies service on Tamsin Roe and Leo Marr through the fictional docket. All names, materials, and access restrictions are part of a synthetic exercise. Nothing in the motion supplies or protects a real cyber instruction.